

POSEY-ONLY WORKING TOOL

Solve Matrix

Built from Justin Posey's own statements and nothing else: the 216 items in "What Justin Posey Has Said." No fan theories, no community solves. Seven matrices, each with blank columns for your own work.

- A** Journey matrix: the poem stage by stage, with the mode, constraints, distances and open questions Posey attached to each
- B** Location filter: every rule that applies to the final spot, with pass/fail boxes for three candidates
- C** Distance and geometry ledger: every statement that carries a length, a direction or a shape
- D** Element matrix: what each part of the hunt (poem, book, map, series, songs, cipher, logo, time) contains and what it is for
- E** Deductions that follow from his words alone, with the chain of citations
- F** Progress timeline: what he says has been solved, and when
- G** Open-question ledger: what he declined, and a specific, not-on-the-nose way to ask it again

Citation key: = section 3, item 4 of the statements list. Tags: C confirmed · S said · L leaned · D declined.

A

JOURNEY MATRIX

The poem stage by stage. Mode and constraints come only from his statements; the Test column is what his words let you check.

STAGE	MODE PER POSEY	WHAT HE CONFIRMED OR SAID	HARD CONSTRAINTS IN FORCE	DISTANCE HE ATTACHED	STILL OPEN (DECLINED)	TEST YOU CAN RUN	YOUR READING
Stanza 1 (1:1–1:4)	Armchair. Not actionable, but 'helpful context'	Every line is helpful; first stanza 'at least a large portion' solved by Sep 2025. Numbers hide in words and wordplay. The element of time is important	No red herrings. Consecutive order	None	Whether it must be rearranged: 'not going to rule that out'	Read it as instructions for reading, not as a place. Count what can be counted	
2:1 As hope surges, clear and bright	Armchair. First actionable clue	The book does not name the specific area but has descriptions that 'pertain to the area'	Free, 24/7, public	None stated here	Whether the surge is water: never asked in his words	Find the book passages that describe terrain, then match	
2:2 Walk near waters' silent flight	Walking distance begins	Walking distance from here through 2:3	No swimming, no dangerous water crossing. Feet wet not required	Walking distance to 2:3	River crossing: not specified	Measure 2:2 to 2:3 on foot; if it needs a car it fails	
2:3 Round the bend, past the Hole	Walking	The Hole has no man-made implication. Not the man-made clue	Not a cave, mine or tunnel	Walking distance from 2:2	Whether the Hole is a hole-named place: 'on the nose'	Your Hole must be natural and on the walk; a culvert, tunnel or mine fails	
2:4 I wait for you to cast your pole	Walking (continues)	Nothing confirmed	—	—	Fishing pole: not specified	Test both readings against 3:1	
3:1 In ursa east his realm awaits	Armchair (stanza 3 is before BOTG)	Only Ursa East matters; no west Ursa. Lowercase intentional. 'He' alive 'depends on your perspective'	Consecutive after 2:4	Not a great distance from the previous clue	'Use a star': no further clarity	Ursa East must be a thing with an east, not a heading	
3:2 His bride stands guard at ancient gates	Armchair	Bride identified by someone. Not alive now; something visible. 'Bride' is the right word. Strange to find the bride without understanding the gates	Gates first, then bride	Bride to treasure: 'a matter of perspective'	Ever alive: 'depends how you define alive'	Name the gates before the bride; if your bride comes first, re-order	
3:3 Her foot of three at twenty degree	Armchair	You do not need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three. Numbers indirect. A distance element exists	Solvable from a map or a distance	'Twenty' and 'three' are the poem's only stated numbers; he keeps wordplay for numbers in play	Nothing declined here	Identify the foot of three from a map. If it needs standing at the bride, it is wrong	

STAGE	MODE PER POSEY	WHAT HE CONFIRMED OR SAID	HARD CONSTRAINTS IN FORCE	DISTANCE HE ATTACHED	STILL OPEN (DECLINED)	TEST YOU CAN RUN	YOUR READING
3:4 Return her face to find the place	Armchair	Her face belongs to the bride. Physical rotation 'technically' yes. Face to place 'not as far as many think'. The place is not necessarily the sacred space	—	Face to place: short	Face or gaze: no clarity	Rotate something physical and see where it points; the place should be near	
4:1 Double arcs on granite bold	Boots on the ground required from here	One clue, depending on path, has a man-made implication; the Hole is not it	Not associated with buildings; exterior of a structure 'always a possibility'	—	Is this the man-made clue: punted. Natural or created: not answered. A bearing: punted	Ask whether the arcs can be seen without being on site; if yes, that contradicts BOTG at stanza 4	
4:2–4:4 Secrets of the past, beyond time's reach, wonder guards this sacred space	Boots on the ground	Sacred space not necessarily the place. Something must be manipulated to see the treasure; a flashlight may help. No clue visible from 15 feet. No blaze on a tree	Not near a trail. Not near graves	Within a mile of the car to figure out where it is	Buried: will not say. Rocks: punted	Your spot must be invisible from 15 feet and off-trail	
Stanza 5	Possibly the last actionable clue	Last actionable clue is stanza four or five 'depending on interpretation'	—	—	—	Decide whether stanza 5 moves you or only warns you	
Checkpoint	Not specified whether before or after boots on the ground	Placed AND already there. Topographic 'implication'. At least halfway through the clues. Hard to get all the way without seeing it. Not in the series	Same rules as the treasure: not underwater, cave, private, graves	Searchers have been within 200 feet of it	Before or after BOTG	Your route must pass something you could photograph and send him	
The final spot	Retrieving, not searching	Only he knows. Important to him, known 'for quite some time'. Kitchen-sized area, unreachable. Below 11,000 ft	All of section 1	A hike is required, length unspecified; a low-rider car reaches the road	Prius within a mile: punted	Run matrix B	—

B

LOCATION FILTER

Every rule he has stated about the final spot, the checkpoint or the route. Mark each candidate ✓ pass, ✕ fail, or ? unknown. One ✕ on a Confirmed row ends the candidate.

RULE	TAG	APPLIES TO	WHAT IT ELIMINATES	CANDIDATE A	CANDIDATE B	CANDIDATE C
Not underwater	CONFIRMED	Treasure, checkpoint, placed clues	Lakebeds, river bottoms, springs you must enter			
Not on private property	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Any spot needing permission; check property lines			
Not in a cave, mine or tunnel	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Caverns, adits, culverts, road tunnels			
Nothing that needs rappelling, ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Cliff faces, canyon drops, islands			
Not associated with man-made buildings; gazebo counts	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Cabins, ruins with roofs, shelters. Exterior of a structure not ruled out			
Not near graves or grave markers	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Cemeteries, battlefield markers, memorial plots			
Not in dangerous places	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	Anything a rescue would be needed for			
Railroad tracks ruled out	CONFIRMED	Site	Trackside, trestles, rail tunnels			
More than one mile from anywhere he, family or friends live, work or own	CONFIRMED	All hunt items	The family cabin's immediate mile, his own properties			
Publicly accessible land; free; 24/7	CONFIRMED	Final location	Fee areas, gated parks, hours-limited sites			
Dogs welcome	CONFIRMED	Final location	Places that bar dogs from the ground you must cross			
No high-clearance vehicle; a low rider reaches the road	CONFIRMED	Approach	Four-wheel-drive-only roads			
Not near any man-made trail, 'a little ways off'	SAID	Site	Trailside caches, trailhead features			
Not more than a mile from the car to figure out where it is	CONFIRMED	Site	Backcountry more than a mile in			

RULE	TAG	APPLIES TO	WHAT IT ELIMINATES	CANDIDATE A	CANDIDATE B	CANDIDATE C
A hike is required	SAID	Site	Drive-up spots, roadside pullouts			
Below 11,000 feet	SAID	Site	High summits and cirques above 11,000			
Built on natural landscape; at most one clue with a man-made implication	SAID	Route	Routes that need two or more man-made features			
No blaze cut on a tree; markers must survive natural forces	SAID	Site and route	Any solve that relies on a carved or painted mark			
Something must be manipulated to see it; flashlight may help	CONFIRMED	Site	Open-ground placements visible on approach			
No significant clue visible from 15 feet	CONFIRMED	Site	Spots marked by an obvious feature at the cache			
You do not have to get your feet wet	CONFIRMED	Route and site	Mid-stream rocks, wading approaches			
Inside the printed map; the American West	SAID	Site	Anything off the map's edge			
Not Colorado; not Oregon (complete elimination: no clues, no treasure)	SAID	Clues and site	Both states entirely. Note the transcript caveat in 8.2			
Not in a pay park or fee area (hub-relayed, secondary)	SAID	Site	Fee-entry parks, unless the hub is wrong			
Physical objects along the way	CONFIRMED	Route	Routes with nothing tangible between clues			
Something along the way is 'pivotal to your journey'	CONFIRMED	Route	Routes with no confidence marker before the end			
Only he knows; never returned since hiding	CONFIRMED	Site	Anything requiring maintenance or a helper			

C

DISTANCE AND GEOMETRY LEDGER

Every statement of his that carries a length, an order, a direction or a shape. Use it to size a candidate route before you drive.

STATEMENT	KIND	WHAT IT FIXES	NUMBER
Walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' through 'past the Hole'	Length	2:2 to 2:3 is on foot	walking
Not more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is	Length	Car to the point of knowing	≤ 1 mile
A hike is required; length withheld	Length	There is a walk; not a pullout	> 0
If you need many bottles of water you are going too far	Length	Short walk, not a day	
Each clue is not meant to convey great distance	Spacing	Clue-to-clue gaps are small	small
First clue to last in miles: impossible to answer given the structure	Structure	The clues are not a simple line	
Distance from the first actionable clue to the treasure: forming the question may give the answer	Structure	The question contains a premise he rejects	
Beginning to end, the poem creates 'some sort of shape'	Shape	The route draws a figure	shape
Indiana Jones and National Treasure, offered instead of linear / points / hybrid	Shape	Leaned toward a device or construction, not a march	
Backtracking: no if you knew the whole solution; yes in the natural progression	Shape	The path re-crosses itself for a first-timer	
You do not need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three	Geometry	The foot is readable from a distance or a map	
Her face to the place: not as far as many think	Length	Short	
Bride to treasure: a matter of perspective	Length	Depends how you measure it	
Return her face implies a physical rotation, technically	Geometry	Something turns	rotation
Twenty degree; foot of three	Numbers	The only numbers in the poem; wordplay for numbers is in play	20, 3
42 is relevant	Number	A number outside the poem matters	42
Clock: the lower the number the better; 4:02 and 5:26 out; clocks are part of the cipher	Number	A clock reading feeds the cipher, not the map	
Below 11,000 feet	Elevation	Ceiling	< 11,000 ft
Within 75 miles of a Fenn search location, then walked back	Radius	Soft	75 mi
Element of time is important	Time	Time matters somewhere in the solve	
Vantage point involved, but no clue is necessarily about it	Geometry	A viewpoint exists in the solve	

STATEMENT	KIND	WHAT IT FIXES	NUMBER
Checkpoint at least halfway through the clues; at least ten clues	Order	Checkpoint at clue 5 or later	≥ 5th clue
Searchers within 200 feet of the checkpoint; within two miles of the treasure	Length	How close the crowd got	200 ft; 2 mi

D

ELEMENT MATRIX

What each part of the hunt is for, in his words. The Required column separates what you must solve from what only helps.

ELEMENT	WHAT HE SAYS IT HOLDS	REQUIRED TO FIND IT?	WHAT IT POINTS TO	STATUS
The poem	All essential clues; at least ten; consecutive; every line helpful; numbers hidden in words	Yes, the whole thing	An exact location when solved in full	Stanza 1, part of 2, part of 3 solved by others
The book	Several hints sprinkled through the stories, not every story; descriptions that pertain to the area; photographs useful; the Tucker poem helpful; dedication layered and intentional; four points of the compass, 'the book is the best reference'	Written so everyone is on equal footing	The area, the person, the container	Read as a memoir first
The map	The treasure is on it; he chose which landmarks are labeled; names, positions and elevations are the designer's and errors are unintentional	'A good primer'	The region	Useful early; still a primer later
Layer five	'Has some bearing on the treasure hunt'	Not stated	Not stated	Undefined
The Netflix series	At least five singular clues plus compound ones; two super obvious hints in an episode 2 or 3 scene without him; hints 'guide you in the book'; checkpoint not shown; Carl scene and Red Mountain clip hold nothing	Hints, not the solution	Back into the book	The two obvious hints were found by Sep 2025
The clock	Part of the cipher; lower number is better; Roman numerals irrelevant; 4:02 and 5:26 out; 'a little uncanny'	Feeds the cipher	The cipher	Open
The songs	Clues in the songs; one 'extremely definitive' clue; a hidden audio message is the technical clue	Technical clue not required	'The key to one direction lies in another'; not the azimuth	Technical clue solved by one person
The cipher	MAGYAR; basic math; a nod to what the container is; gives no coordinates, state or region; 'who says it's in the book'	No	The container	Solved April 2026
The logo	Angzarr, chosen and modified intentionally; 'has some meaning'	Not stated	Not stated	Open
42	'The short answer is yes'; Hitchhiker's Guide	Not stated	Not stated	Open
Time	'The element of time is important'; no time travel	Not stated	Not stated	Open
The checkpoint	Placed and already there; topographic implication; halfway or later; pivotal	Practically yes: hard to get all the way without it	Confidence that you are on the path	Reached within 200 ft by some; no correct photo
The container	An existing object with deliberate modifications; recognizable to anyone who read the book or saw the series; not a box; Saddleback briefcase is what carried it, not what holds it	Recognize it on sight	Itself	Guessed correctly by some

E DEDUCTIONS THAT FOLLOW FROM HIS WORDS ALONE

These are inferences, not statements. Each one shows the statements of his it rests on, so you can break the chain if you disagree with a link.

#	DEDUCTION	RESTS ON	CONFIDENCE
1	Stanzas 1 to 3 are solvable from home even though stanza 2 describes walking. The walk is described before it is taken.	Boots on the ground required only at stanza four + a fair amount solvable from home + walking distance 2:2 to 2:3	High
2	The checkpoint is at or after the fifth clue, so it is in stanza 3 or later.	At least ten clues + at least halfway when you reach it + consecutive order	High
3	The checkpoint is a natural feature that he added something to, or a placed thing set at a natural feature.	Both placed and already there + topographic implication + not something you need to worry about moving + hunt items obey the rules	High
4	The bride is a visible landform or object, identified by its gates first. Anything alive, or anything found before its gates, is wrong.	Not alive now, something visible + strange to find her without the gates + 'bride' is the right word	High
5	'Ursa east' names a thing that has an east, not a direction to walk.	Only Ursa East matters, no west Ursa + lowercase intentional	High
6	Stanza 3 is a construction on a map: a foot found at a distance, a rotation, and a short hop to the place.	Foot of three without being at the bride + rotation technically yes + face to place short + Indiana Jones / National Treasure + shape	Medium
7	'The place' (3:4) and 'the sacred space' (4:4) can be two spots, so the stanza 3 construction may deliver you somewhere that stanza 4 then moves you from.	Not necessarily the same + boots on the ground from stanza four	Medium
8	The one man-made implication, if it exists on your path, sits in stanza 4, because the Hole is cleared and stanza 3 is map work.	Hole not man-made + one clue may have a man-made implication depending on path + arcs question punted + exterior of a structure possible	Medium
9	The final spot is within a mile of a car, reached by a real but short walk, off any trail, and not obvious from 15 feet.	Not more than a mile + hike required + not near a trail + nothing visible from 15 feet + manipulate something to see it	High
10	Whether the treasure is buried does not change the solve; the poem delivers an exact location regardless.	'Wouldn't matter either way' + exact location on full solve	High
11	The cipher does not locate anything. Solving MAGYAR tells you what to look for, not where.	MAGYAR gives no coordinates, state or region + a nod to the container + not critical	High
12	The book describes the area without naming it, so terrain descriptions in the stories are the best filter for the first actionable clue.	Specific area not mentioned but descriptions pertain to it + hints sprinkled, not in every story + first actionable clue is 2:1	High
13	The crowd's best position is 200 feet from the checkpoint and outside the kitchen-sized area, so the checkpoint is not at the treasure.	200 feet from the checkpoint + kitchen-sized area unreached + no correct checkpoint photo	Medium
14	Some part of the solve depends on time (a date, an hour, a season, an age), and it is not a rule about when to visit.	Element of time important + 24/7 access + clues stand the test of time	Medium
15	Spoken answers are less reliable than written ones, by his own account. Weight the rules, the FAQ and his posts above any podcast reply.	Prefers written responses to avoid errors + off-the-cuff forum replies can muddy the waters	High

F

PROGRESS TIMELINE

What he says has been solved, in order. The gap between six clues and the kitchen-sized area is where the hunt stands.

DATE	WHAT HE SAID	SOLVED SO FAR (HIS COUNT)
Mar 28 2025	Not found	—
Apr 9 2025	Only he knows; 'who says it's a box'; cipher toward poem or book not specified	—
Jun 21 2025	Within two miles; nobody at the checkpoint; nobody has said the cipher answer; no state ruled out; below 11,000 ft	Under two clues implied
Aug 1 2025	Several have solved at least the first two clues; some within 200 ft of the checkpoint; zero correct photos	2 clues
Sep 2025	Stanza 1 and at least part of stanza 2 solved; searchers 'quite close'; the two obvious Netflix hints found	Stanza 1 + part of 2
Mar 28 2026	Bride identified; part of stanza 3 solved; at least six clues by the most advanced searcher; kitchen-sized area unreached; nobody way off, nobody uber close	6 clues
Apr 2026	Cipher solved: MAGYAR; technical clue confirmed	Cipher done
Jul 2026	Marked-book prize found, not the treasure; monthly Featured Question begins	—

WHAT "SIX CLUES" CAN COVER

With at least ten clues in consecutive order, six solved clues starting at 2:1 reach into stanza 3, which matches "part of stanza 3 solved" and "bride identified". So the frontier is between the bride and the foot of three, or between the foot and the rotation. Nobody has reported the arcs.

USE OF THE TIMELINE

If your solve places the checkpoint before the bride, it must explain how searchers were within 200 feet of the checkpoint in Aug 2025 while stanza 3 was unsolved until 2026. If it places the checkpoint after the bride, the 200-foot group had solved more than he credited them with at the time. Either way, write down which.

G

OPEN-QUESTION LEDGER

Everything he refused, with his stated reason. He answers questions that are specific but not on the nose. The suggested rewordings are drafts for the monthly Featured Question, not facts.

WHAT HE DECLINED	WHY IT WAS REFUSED (HIS WORDS)	A SPECIFIC, NOT-ON-THE-NOSE WAY TO ASK	YOUR NOTE
Does the Hole correspond to a hole-named place?	'An on the nose question'	Is the Hole something a fisherman would call a hole?	
Is 'double arcs' the man-made clue? Natural or created?	Punted; 'he knows what he knows'	Were the double arcs there before you first visited the site?	
Is 'double arcs' a bearing?	Punted	Do the double arcs stay in one place through the year?	
Is the place in her face or her gaze?	No clarity	When her face is returned, does the place lie in front of her or behind her?	
Is the checkpoint before or after boots on the ground?	Not specified; may reconsider	Can a searcher describe the checkpoint to you accurately without having stood at it?	
Do you need to move rocks?	Punted	Is what must be manipulated lighter than the treasure?	
Is it buried?	AI could use it	Skip; he has stated it does not change the solve	
Are national parks ruled out?	Will not say yes or no	Is the final location on land where a dog may go off-trail on a leash?	
Is 'cast your pole' a fishing pole?	Not specified	Would the person in 'I wait for you' be standing in water or beside it?	
Can a Prius get within a mile?	Punted	Is the last road before the walk paved?	
Does the hunt require a river crossing?	Not specified	Is every hunt item on the same side of every river it is near?	
Does the site predate your Fenn searches?	Not specified	Did you know the site before 2010?	
Which animal did you see?	Would affect the search area	Is the animal's range on the printed map limited to one state?	
The one question nobody has asked	He cannot verbalize it	Work backward from 'the key to one direction lies in another' and the element of time	